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Title:
Locked Away

Author:
Martin Aloia

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(We see a dark, dreary cell block.)

Inmates: November first.

(An ambiguously ethnic inmate in the featured cell, SPAZ kneels, begins to pray.)

Spaz: God...please forgive me for all that I've done. I know it's been a little while since we've talked, but...hey that's life, right? Just like why I'm in here. Just...life.

(A stiff, white prisoner, AMY, gets thrown into the cell.)

Amy: No, please! Let me go! Don't! You can't put me in here!
(Spaz sizes her up.)
Spaz: Are you beef?
Amy: Uh...What?
Spaz: Are you beef??
Amy: What do you--
Spaz: Are you beef?!?
Amy: I don't under--
Spaz: ARE YOU BEEF?!
Amy: AHH PLEASE DON'T HURT ME!
(Spaz pulls back with a smile.)
Spaz: Nah, you chicken. *(laughs)* Man you should've seen the look on your face! I was all 'blah!' and you were all like 'Oh my gosh, this ethnic girl is trouble!' Too much, man.
Amy: Um. I think I'll go to bed now if that's okay.
Spaz: It's not okay.
Amy: It's not?
Spaz: No.
Amy: Why?
Spaz: You think you're sleeping tonight? Or ever again?
Amy: Please, I--
Spaz: Pfft, man you ain't got no backbone. You can't just let people push you around like that, stick up for yourself! Chicken.
Amy: Sorry...
Spaz: So what'd a pretty little white girl like you do to get in here anyway? Parents not like your report card or somethin'?
Amy: I, uh...uh...nothing. What about you?
Spaz: Yeah. Nothing.

Inmates: November second…

(Spaz and Amy file through the cafeteria as slop gets piled onto their trays.)
Amy: Is that meat?
Spaz: Ooh, give me some of that orange stuff! Yeah. I miss you orange!
Amy: No, no, I don't eat dairy! Or...whatever that is!
Spaz: C'mon Ricky. You know you can give me more brown bits than that. *(gets it)* There ya go!
(Spaz goes into the seating area.)
Amy: I just...no thanks.
(Amy heads into the seating area. She hesitates, not knowing where to sit. She chooses the seat next to Spaz. A few spoonfuls in, she begins crying.)

Spaz: Uh…are you crying?
Amy: *(crying)* No...
Spaz: Uh. Why--
Amy: All I want is a Cinnabon and a cute pair of jeans!
Spaz: Oh. Oh girl...Nah, nah. You can't cry in here. Like, seriously, stop.
Amy: I just...I'm so scared...
Spaz: Someone will hurt you...
Amy: I don't know what's going on...
Spaz: Please, stop!
Amy: And I hate this place--
Spaz: Well yeah. You only like white people.
Amy: ...What?!
Spaz: Pfft don't even try to deny it! You should've seen how you was lookin' at me when you first got in here. I bet the only time you like seeing colored people is when their last name is Kardashian.
Amy: No, I love all minorities--
Spaz: What's wrong with me? Huh? Yo I got a big butt too!
(She flashes her butt. Amy shields her eyes.)
Amy: I'm sure you do, now put that thing away!
Spaz: Calm down girl, I'm just messing with you!
Amy: ...You are?!
Spaz: Yeah!
Amy: Oh thank god! Wait. Why were you messing with me?!
Spaz: Had to get you to stop crying somehow. You're welcome. Man, you're like this sad little puppy that just gets pushed around all the time. It's pretty hilarious.
Amy: Great. I'm glad the puppy-chicken amuses you.

Inmates: December 18th.

(Amy and Spaz fold towels in the laundry room. Amy struggles—Spaz excels.)

Amy: You know, being in here reminds me of summer camp. That place went through so many towels, I felt like I spent every summer working an unpaid internship at a laundromat. And I still suck at folding. Holy crap you work fast. How do you fold like that?
Spaz: What? Oh I get it. You think all my people are born to be maids, don't you?
Amy: Come on, Spaz, you know that's not what I meant, why do you just keep twisting my words--
Spaz: Ooh is chicken standing up for herself?
Amy: --Jesus, I'm just trying to make conversation--
Spaz: Hold on. Did you really just say Jesus like that?
Amy: What? Yeah...I mean, I saw you praying on the first day but I didn't think...
Spaz: We've got to get back to work.
Amy: Spaz…It's fine if you're religious and all...
Spaz: No, Amy! It's not about religion. To save my sister I took someone's life. Okay? It's as simple as that. No church on Sundays, family grace before dinner. I'm not going to pretend I'm perfect... that my past isn't filled with more pain than you could imagine...But I'm also not going to stand here and let you disrespect Jesus when he's the only friend I have left. But you don't get it. How could you? You never will. You'll never understand.
Amy: Maybe I won't, but...You know, I'm not perfect either. When my mom died... Everything fell apart. I mean, I felt so alone...just that gnawing loneliness that makes every breath feel like a crime. I kept feeling that crushing weight inside until one day I just...broke. I got so drunk on whatever I could find that I don't even remember how many cars I crashed into. I could've killed so many people, I-I mean they say I didn't, but does that matter? Spaz. I'm just as much of a killer as you.
(Spaz walks over to show Amy how to fold.)
Spaz: No. Like this...

Inmates: December twenty-fifth.

(Amy and Spaz face each other in their cell.)

Amy: Well, I know it's not much, but. It's the thought that counts, right?
(She hands Spaz a few cigarettes.)
Spaz: Aw, cigarettes! Man, thank you.
Amy: Sorry that's all I could afford.
Spaz: Pfft don't you even sorry me. Here's your present.
(Guess what it is...)
Amy: Aw, you got me cigarettes too!
Spaz: Merry Christmas Amy!

Amy: *(laughing)* Merry Christmas Spaz. *(stares at the cigs)* Do you miss your family?
Spaz: Yeah.
Amy: How do you deal with it?
Spaz: Well, I know I kind of have to, so I just...do. You know?
Amy: No. No, I don't. I'm sitting here wondering what they're doing right now, what kind of random food my dad's put on the table, my sisters fighting over some comment about their hair...it's dumb but it was home. You know?
Spaz: Yeah. I know.

Inmates: January fourth.

(Amy sits on her bed, scratching tallies into the wall. Spaz does push-ups on the floor.)

Amy: One month, twenty-seven days...
Spaz: What are you doing over there, robot?
Amy: That's fifty-eight days, twenty-four hours in a day...
Spaz: You that excited to get away from your beautiful and talented and gorgeously awesome cellmate?
Amy: Spaz. I just finally have something to look forward to for the first time in a long time. In just under two months, that's something like one thousand hours...I get a chance at freedom. I get a chance at parole.
Spaz: Man, we have got to find a better way to keep you entertained if parole is a shining future to you.
Amy: Oh yeah? What are you, a connoisseur of in-prison entertainment?
Spaz: No, but I figure hanging out with me is better than scraping a penny against the wall all day.
Amy: Hm. Point taken.

Inmates: January tenth.

(Amy and Spaz face each other, fingers all up.)

Amy: Okay, okay okay. So I say something like...never have I ever...skydived. Sky-dove…? Doesn't matter.
Spaz: Pfft, loser.
Amy: And you have?
Spaz: No.
Amy: That's what I thought. So, if you had answered yes, you would've put a finger down. Since it was a no, you're fine. Got it?
Spaz: Okay okay, I think I got it. Let me try…um...I've never ever...ever...

Amy: Mhm…?
Spaz: *(breaking game)* Have you ever been in love?
Amy: Yeah, like that! You've got it.
Spaz: Yeah, yeah, okay. Let's play for real now.

Inmates: February thirteenth.

(Amy and Spaz lie on their backs, staring at the ceiling as they laugh together.)

Spaz: And so the guy's popping out of the suitcase, right? And he goes, "I can hardly contain myself!"
(They burst out laughing. It comes to a stop soon after.)
Amy: I think we need better prison jokes.
Spaz: Alright, uh...two priests walk into a cell.
Amy: You told that one.
Spaz: Two bankers walk into a cell.
Amy: I told that one.
Spaz: Two talking monkeys walk into a cell.
Amy: What? How does that one go?
Spaz: I don't know, I was hoping you knew.

Inmates: March second.

(Spaz sweeps the concrete hallway. Amy rushes up to surprise her.)

Amy: Spaz...Spaz Spaz Spaz Spaz Spaz!
Spaz: Chicken chicken chicken chicken chicken! How'd the parole meeting go?
Amy: Okay, it was like...the weirdest job interview of all time, but...I got it!
Spaz: Yeeeeah, Freebird in the house!
Amy: Woo-hoo!
Spaz: Look out world, we've got a free-range chicken on the loose!
Amy: *(laughs)* Oh Spaz, seriously, thanks for everything. There's no way I could've made it out of here without you.
Spaz: Nah man. That's what I keep trying to tell you--you can make it through anything. You just gotta believe in yourself for a change.
Amy: Sooo, when's your meeting?
Spaz: Never...
Amy: What? Spaz, but--
Spaz: I don't get a meeting.

Amy: C'mon, how could you not get a meeting? You're not...
Spaz: Amy.
Amy: You're not in here for good...are you?

Inmates: March third.

(Spaz shoots a basketball on the outdoor court. Amy walks up.)
Amy: Nice shot.
Spaz: Thanks, Free-Range...So. How does it feel knowing this is your last day in paradise?
Amy: Yeah, paradise. It's gonna be such a drag when I go home, sit on my couch and eat ice cream for ten straight hours. The torture.
Spaz: You wanna play?
Amy: Oh no, I'm so bad at sports--for your own safety, it's best that we don't.
Spaz: Come on, one play. Get over there.
Amy: No, really--
(Spaz positions Amy across from her.)
Spaz: Ready?
Amy: No.
Spaz: Alright, here we go.
Amy: No, no--
(Spaz dribbles a few times, quickly fakes out Amy and hits the layup.)
Spaz: Oh boy--
Amy: I told you I was terrible!
Spaz: And you were right! Good thing you make up for it in other areas.
Amy: Oh, I do, do I? In what areas exactly?
Spaz: Pfft, just drop it, you ego-head.
Amy: Okay. Fine. Consider it dropped.
Spaz: You know, I thought we changed that about you.
Amy: Changed what?
Spaz: You're about to head off into the free world and you still don't have any balls, man.
Amy: I do too!
Spaz: No way. Here, come on, yell at me.
Amy: What?
Spaz: Yell at me. Let's see what you got.
Amy: I'm not gonna--
Spaz: Do it! You're not getting out of this prison until you yell at me!
Amy: No way!
Spaz: WHY NOT?!
Amy: Because...I'm Amy!

Spaz: --Uh-huh--
Amy: And...I'm awesome!
Spaz: --Yeah--
Amy: And you can't tell me what to do, because I am YELLING AT YOU HOW COOL IS THIS?!
Spaz: SO COOL!
Amy: I AM FEARLESS AND GLORIOUS--
Spaz: Bye bye chicken!
Amy: AND I WILL NOT HOLD BACK--
Spaz: Hallelujah praise the lord!
Amy: AND I WILL GO WHEREVER MY HEART LEADS ME!
Spaz: No one can stop y--

(Amy grabs Spaz, kisses her. They remain frozen in the moment. Amy's eyes widen.)
Amy: Oh my god, oh I'm sorry, I...I don't know what I was thinking, I...I…
Spaz: Amy....
Amy: I think that...I was just, I--
Spaz: Don't.
Amy: Don't what?
Spaz: Don't do this to me.
Amy: Do what?
Spaz: This.
Amy: Spaz…
Spaz: Amy.
Amy: It's okay--
Spaz: NO! It's not okay! It's okay for you because in a few hours you're gonna walk out that door and get your old life back. Well I'll still be here. I'll always be here. Don't you get that? I took a man's life so they took mine too. Please...don't even look at me. I lost my chance with you before we even met. Just...don't make me fall in love with you any more than I already have. Because at this point it's no longer love, it's just...pain.
Amy: Spaz…
Spaz: Just go. For your own sake. And don't look back. Forget me and live the life you're lucky enough to be getting back.
Amy: Oh come on Spaz, even if I wanted to, I couldn't forget you. When I walk out that door, my heart's gonna stay here. Locked away, guilty of falling in love with some crazy girl I slept across from in my cell. Look...I won't make you say goodbye. But please believe me when I say that I'll be back. Beef.
Spaz: Chicken.

(Amy walks out. Spaz drops to her knee, begins praying.)

Spaz: God...please. Tell me she’ll be back.